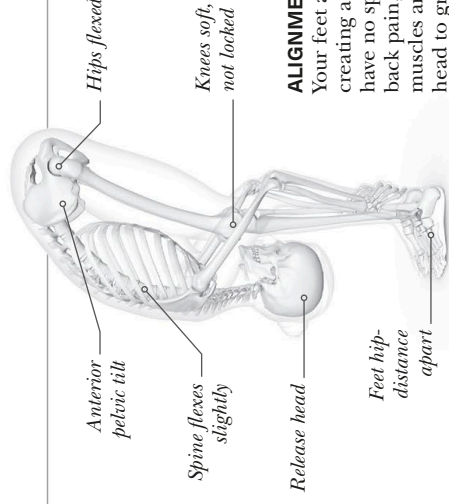


FORWARD FOLD

Uttanasana

Forward Fold offers an opportunity to improve flexibility. Transitioning in and out of the pose, such as in Sun salutations, will help prepare you for common functional movements you do throughout the day. This pose can be adapted for all abilities by going into the fold less deeply.



ALIGNMENT

Your feet are at hip distance, creating a stable base. If you have no spinal problems or back pain, relax your neck muscles and release your head to gravity.

THE BIG PICTURE

The back of your whole body is stretching—including your calf muscles, thighs, buttocks, and back muscles. At the front of your body—especially in your legs—your muscles are working to stabilize you in the deep bend.

Neck and torso

All of your **spinal extensors** and your **latissimus dorsi** stretch when you release your upper body to gravity.

Thighs

Your **gluteus maximus, medius, and minimus, hamstrings, and adductor magnus** stretch strongly in this pose while your **hip flexors** engage. Your **quadriceps** extend the knees and stabilize your base of support.

